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The 2027 Restart Workbook

Version 1.3

A GIFT FOR THE ATTENDEES OF

What Will You Do To Change Your Life In 2027?

Saturday, November 7, 2026 | 4:00 PM EST | Zoom



THIS WORKBOOK BELONGS TO:

My start date: Mon, Nov 9, 2026

My finish line: Thur, Dec 31, 2026

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STARTHERE

Welcome

You made time on a Saturday to plan your future. Most people never do.

This workbook turns today's session into action. It is not a book to read. It is a set ofworking manuals: short, practical guides where you do the work on the page, step by step, until you have a real plan for 2027 and a clear 54 day sprint to finish 2026 strong.

Every manual follows the same pattern, so you always know where you are:

- **Why it matters.** The idea in plain words, with the research behind it.
- **How to do it.** Numbered steps. Follow them in order.
- **Fill it in.** Worksheets, tables, and prompts. Write in the boxes.
- **Check yourself.** A short checklist so you know the manual is truly done.

Three ways to use this workbook

Live, during the session. Complete the quick steps we do together. Your facilitator will tell you which page to open.

This weekend. Finish Manuals 1 to 4 by Sunday night. They give you your starting point, your why, and your goal.

Over the next 54 days. Run Manuals 5 to 12 like a project. Use the weekly reviews at the back every Sunday.

Five rules for working in this workbook

1. **Be honest, not impressive.** Nobody grades this. Write what is true.
2. **Be specific.** "Get better at my career" is a wish. "Finish the first certification module by Friday" is a plan.
3. **Numbers beat adjectives.** Wherever you can, count something.
4. **Done beats perfect.** A rough answer today is worth more than a perfect answer in January.
5. **Tell one person.** Plans that live only in your head are easy to drop. Share one goal with someone today.

You can type directly into this document, print it, or copy the tables into a notebook. Everything works either way.

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The twelve manuals at a glance

#	Manual	Time	You will leave with
1	The 2026 Look Back	30 min	A written record of your wins, lessons, and what gives you energy
2	The Life Audit	25 min	Honest scores across eight life areas and your biggest gap
3	Your Why and Your 2027 Vision	40 min	Your top five values, your why, and a headline from December 2027
4	The Goal Builder	45 min	One clear goal for 2027, supporting goals, and a quarter by quarter map
5	The Career Roadmap	60 min	Target roles, a three skill plan, a proof portfolio, and an interview story bank
6	The Premortem	20 min	The three most likely reasons your plan could fail, each with a safeguard
7	The Habit Design Lab	30 min	One or two habits designed to stick, with a 54 day tracker
8	The People Plan	40 min	A personal board, ten reconnect messages, and a giving plan
9	Money and Negotiation Prep	45 min	Your market range, your walk away point, and a rehearsed script
10	The Focus and Energy System	30 min	A weekly time map, a focus routine, and a body reset plan
11	Mind and Confidence	30 min	An evidence file, a gratitude log, and a kinder inner voice
12	The 54 Day Sprint	40 min	Your week by week plan from November 9 to December 31
B	**BONUS: The Mentorship Decision Kit**	45 min	An ROI calculator, a scorecard, ten questions to ask any program, and proof you can check

At the back: weekly and monthly review pages, your commitment contract, a script library, interview prep, the research behind each manual, and notes pages for today's session.

Before you start: the five minute setup

- ☐ Find a quiet spot and put your phone in another room.
- ☐ Have water and a pen or an open document ready.
- ☐ Decide the one area of life you most want to change in 2027.
- ☐ Write today's date and one word for how you feel about 2027 at the top of the Look Back page.

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MANUAL 1

The 2026 Look Back

You cannot plan well from a blurry picture of where you stand.

TIME NEEED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
30 minutes	Evidence file, lessons list, and an energy audit	Today or tomorrow, before you set any goals

Why it matters

Most people remember the year through their last difficult month, so they underrate what they did. A written record fixes that. Researchers who studied thousands of work diaries (Teresa Amabile and Steven Kramer, The Progress Principle) found that seeing progress in meaningful work is one of the strongest drivers of motivation. Writing your wins down is how you see them.

How to do it

1. **Set a timer for five minutes per quarter.** Go through your calendar, email, messages, and photos to jog your memory.
2. **Record wins in the table below.** Include results delivered, problems solved, skills learned, certifications, feedback received, people helped, and risks taken.
3. **Add a number wherever you can.** Hours saved, people helped, tickets resolved, dollars earned, applications sent.
4. **Name what worked and what did not.** Be fair to yourself and honest about what did not work.
5. **Complete the energy audit.** Note what gave you energy and what drained it. This points toward your best direction.

1A. The Evidence File

Aim for at least eight entries. This table becomes the raw material for your resume, LinkedIn, interviews, and salary conversations.

Quarter	What I did	What changed because of it (use numbers)
Q1 Jan to Mar		
Q1 Jan to Mar		
Q2 Apr to Jun		
Q2 Apr to Jun		
Q3 Jul to Sep		
Q3 Jul to Sep		

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Quarter	What I did	What changed because of it (use numbers)
Q4 Oct to Now		
Q4 Oct to Now		

1B. What worked, what did not

What worked (keep it)	What did not work (drop or fix it)	What I will do differently in 2027

1C. The Energy Audit

Think about activities, people, projects, and settings from this year.

Gave me energy	Drained my energy

KEEP doing	STOP doing	START doing

1D. Three sentences to close the year

2026 taught me that...

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I am proud that...

I am ready to let go of...

Check yourself

☐ I wrote at least eight wins.

☐ At least three of them include a number.

☐ I named one lesson I will apply immediately.

☐ I can say in one sentence what 2026 taught me.

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MANUAL 2

The Life Audit

A career cannot thrive when the rest of life is collapsing. Check all eight areas.

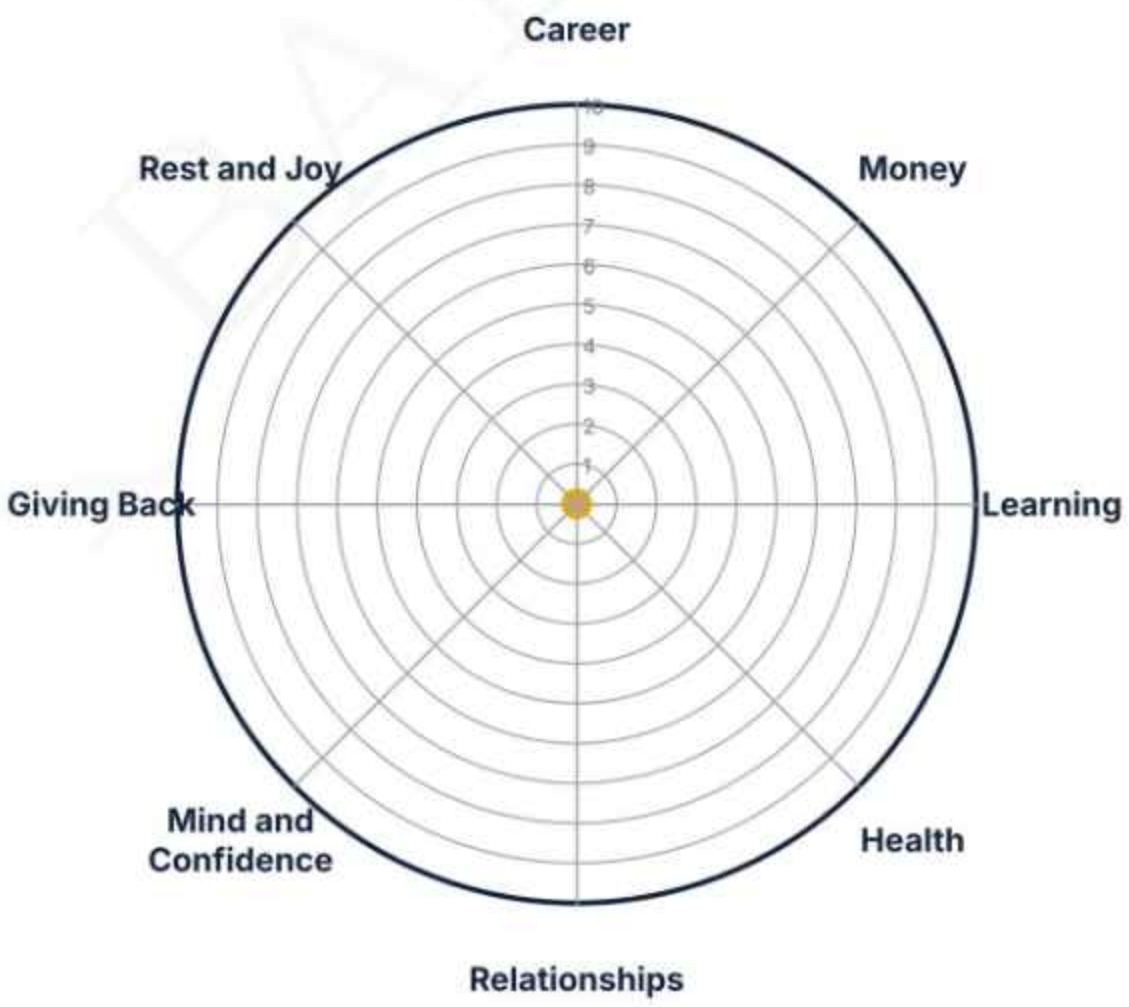
TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
25 minutes	Eight honest scores and your single biggest gap	Right after the Look Back

Why it matters

Careers, relationships, health, and confidence feed one another. When one area is neglected for long enough, it eventually drags the rest down. This audit takes a snapshot of all of them so that your 2027 plan is built on the whole picture, not just the work part.

How to do it

1. **Read the eight areas** in the table on the next page. For each, write what a 10 out of 10 would look like **for you,** not for anyone else.
2. **Score yourself honestly from 1 to 10** for today. Use the first number that comes to mind.
3. **Score where you want to be** by December 31, 2027. A realistic gain is one to three points per area, not ten.
4. **Shade the wheel.** Color or draw a line to each score. The shape that appears shows your balance.
5. **Pick one or two gaps.** The area that is lowest, or the one that would lift the others most, becomes your priority in Manual 4.



Mark each score on its spoke, with 1 at the center and 10 on the outer ring, then connect the dots.

2A. Score your eight areas

Area	What a 10 looks like for me	Now (1 to 10)	Dec 2027 target	One thing that would add a point
Career				
Money				
Learning				
Health				
Relationships				
Mind and confidence				
Giving back				
Rest and joy				

2B. The four restart checks

Tick what is already true. Whatever is left unticked is where a small restart will pay off.

Career

☐ I can name the work that excites me and the work that drains me.
☐ I have written goals with a yearly, monthly, and weekly layer.
☐ I know the three skills I am building next, and I have scheduled time for them.
☐ I have spoken to a mentor or inspiring colleague in the last 90 days.
☐ I protect my working hours and I am not running on empty.
☐ My LinkedIn profile shows my recent results.

Relationships

☐ I told someone this month, specifically, what I appreciate about them.
☐ I have reached out to a friend I have not spoken to in a while.
☐ I have regular phone free time with people I care about.
☐ I listen without planning my reply.
☐ I spend more time with people who lift me than with people who drain me.
☐ I have set at least one clear boundary where I needed one.

Health

☐ I sleep at least seven hours most nights (adult guidance is seven or more).
☐ I move my body most days in a way that fits my life.
☐ My meals are mostly nourishing, and snacks and fast food are the exception.
☐ I drink water through the day and take short breaks from sitting.

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☐ I spend a few quiet minutes each day settling my mind.
☐ My checkups and appointments are up to date.

Self esteem and mind

☐ I treat my mental health as a priority and rest in more than one way.
☐ I speak to myself the way I would speak to a friend.
☐ I measure myself against last year's me, not against other people's highlights.
☐ I notice good things daily and say them out loud or write them down.
☐ I try one new thing every month.
☐ My digital life is tidy: subscriptions, photos, and contacts are under control.

This workbook is general education, not medical advice. If low mood, anxiety, or stress feels heavy or lasts, please speak with a doctor or licensed professional.

2C. Your gap

My lowest score is in... and the reason is...

The area that would lift the others most if I improved it is...

In 2027 I will give most of my attention to these two areas:

Check yourself

☐ All eight areas have a score and a target.
☐ I picked one or two priority areas, not five.
☐ I can name one small action that would add a point to each priority area.

MANUAL 3

Your Why and Your 2027 Vision

A goal without a reason fades in February. A goal with a reason survives it.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
40 minutes	Top five values, your written why, and a headline from the future	When you have quiet and no interruptions

Why it matters

Your why is what you read on the days motivation is gone. Your values decide what you say yes and no to. Your vision gives your goals a destination. Without these three, goals become a to do list. With them, they become a direction.

How to do it

1. **Choose your values.** Tick up to ten that feel true, then circle your top five.
2. **Say what each value looks like in action.** A value you cannot describe in behavior is only a word.
3. **Write your why** using the prompts. Do not edit as you write.
4. **Write the headline** from December 31, 2027, as if the year went well, then fill in the story beneath it.
5. **Answer the six vision prompts** in one or two sentences each.

3A. Values: tick what feels true

☐ Achievement	☐ Adventure	☐ Authenticity	☐ Balance	☐ Community
☐ Courage	☐ Creativity	☐ Curiosity	☐ Discipline	☐ Excellence
☐ Faith	☐ Family	☐ Freedom	☐ Generosity	☐ Growth
☐ Health	☐ Impact	☐ Independence	☐ Integrity	☐ Joy
☐ Leadership	☐ Learning	☐ Mastery	☐ Peace	☐ Recognition
☐ Security	☐ Service	☐ Stability	☐ Wealth	☐ Wisdom

My top five values	What this value looks like in my daily behavior

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3B. My why

I want to change my life in 2027 because...

If I do nothing, a year from now I will probably...

The people who benefit if I succeed are...

On hard days I will remind myself that...

3C. A headline from December 31, 2027

Write as if a journalist is reporting on your year. Make it specific and true to what you want.

HEADLINE

What happened (three sentences):

What I did in the first 90 days that made it possible:

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3D. Six vision prompts

Prompt	In December 2027...
Where I work and what I do	
What I earn and how I manage money	
How my body and mind feel	
Who is in my life and how we spend time	
What I am known for	
What I have learned and mastered	

Check yourself

☐ I have five values and can describe each in behavior.

☐ My why is written and I could read it aloud on a hard day.

☐ My headline is specific enough that I would recognize it if it came true.

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MANUAL 4

The Goal Builder

Specific, challenging goals tend to beat vague encouragement.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
45 minutes	One main goal, supporting goals, and a quarter by quarter map for 2027	After Manuals 1 to 3

Why it matters

Edwin Locke and Gary Latham, whose goal setting theory is among the most tested in workplace psychology, found that specific and challenging goals generally lead to better performance than telling yourself to "do your best." Specific means you can tell, on a given date, whether you did it or not.

How to do it

1. **Choose ONE main goal for 2027.** It should come from your priority gap in Manual 2 and your why in Manual 3.
2. **Run the quality check below.** Rewrite until every box is ticked.
3. **Fill in the goal sheet,** including the first three tasks and the person you will tell.
4. **Add supporting goals** for the other life areas. One each, at most.
5. **Map it across 2027** quarter by quarter, then pull out this month and this week.

4A. The goal quality check

☐ **Specific.** A stranger could read it and know exactly what I mean.
☐ **Measurable.** There is a number, a date, or an observable result.
☐ **Time bound.** It has a deadline.
☐ **Challenging but possible.** It stretches me without being fantasy.
☐ **Mine.** I want it, and it is not only someone else's expectation.
☐ **Controllable.** It is about actions I control, not only outcomes others decide.

Weak: "Get a better job." Strong: "Apply to 40 roles in my target field and complete three interviews by March 31, 2027."

4B. The goal sheet

Item	My answer
My main goal for 2027 (one sentence)	
How I will measure success	
Deadline	
Why it matters to me	

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Item	My answer
The biggest risk to it	
First three tasks (with dates)	
Who I will tell, and by when	
Support I need and from whom	
How I will reward myself	

4C. Supporting goals

Area	Goal	Measure	Deadline
Career skills			
Relationships			
Health			
Mind and confidence			
Money			

4D. The 2027 map

Quarter	Theme	Main goal progress by quarter end	Review date
Q1 Jan to Mar			Mar 31
Q2 Apr to Jun			Jun 30
Q3 Jul to Sep			Sep 30
Q4 Oct to Dec			Dec 31

4E. Pull it down to this month and this week

Horizon	What I will complete
This week (by Sunday)	

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Horizon	What I will complete
This month (by Dec 1)	
By Dec 31, 2026	

Check yourself

- ☐ My main goal passes all six quality checks.
- ☐ I know my first three tasks and their dates.
- ☐ I told one person about my goal today.
- ☐ My 2027 map has a review date for every quarter.

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MANUAL 5

The Career Roadmap

Know where you are going, what to build, and how to prove it.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
60 minutes	Target roles, a three skill plan, a proof portfolio, and your story bank	After setting your main goal

Why it matters

Careers move when three things line up: a clear destination, skills that match it, and visible proof that you have them. Most people work on skills and forget the proof, or collect proof with no destination. This manual links all three. It works for technical and non technical roles alike.

How to do it

1. **List up to five target roles** and score your fit honestly.
2. **Capture what you learn in the session** about the top roles for 2027 in the notes box.
3. **Pick only three skillsto build first.** Too many skills means none of them get finished.
4. **Build a proof portfolio.** Every skill needs evidence a stranger can see.
5. **Refresh your LinkedIn** using the checklist.
6. **Track every application** and prepare four interview stories before you need them.

5A. Destination: target roles

Role I am considering	Why it interests me	Skills it requires	Fit (1 to 5)	Next step

From today's session: top roles for 2027

Write the roles you heard about, what they do, and which ones fit you.

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5B. Skills: the three skill plan

Skill	Level now (1 to 5)	Level needed (1 to 5)	How I will close the gap	Hours per week	Done by

Parking lot (skills I will NOT work on yet, so I stop worrying about them):

5C. Proof: your portfolio

Anything a recruiter, manager, or client can look at: a project, a write up, a presentation, a certification, a recommendation, a case study.

Project or result	What it proves	Where it lives (link)	Status

5D. LinkedIn refresh checklist

- ☐ **Headline** says what I do and who I help, not only my job title (see the formula in the Script Library).
- ☐ **About** section opens with a hook, shows proof, says what I am looking for, and ends with how to reach me.
- ☐ **Experience** lists results with numbers, not only duties.
- ☐ **Featured** section shows my best project, write up, or certification.
- ☐ **Skills** lists the ones I want to be found for, in priority order.
- ☐ **Photo and banner** are clear, current, and professional.
- ☐ **Recommendations:** I have asked for at least two this month.

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☐ **Activity:** I post or comment about my field at least once a week.

☐ **Contact settings** are set so recruiters can reach me.

5E. The application tracker

Company	Role	Date applied	Contact	Status	Next step and date

5F. The interview story bank

Use the STAR method:S ituation,Task,Action,Result. Prepare four stories that you can bend to answer many questions: a win, a failure, a conflict, and a time you led or influenced.

Story 1: A win I am proud of	
Situation	
Task	
Action (what I did)	
Result (with numbers)	
Skills it proves	

Story 2: A failure and what I learned	
Situation	
Task	
Action (what I did)	

Story 2: A failure and what I learned	
Result (with numbers)	
Skills it proves	

Story 3: A conflict I resolved	
Situation	
Task	
Action (what I did)	
Result (with numbers)	
Skills it proves	

Story 4: A time I led or influenced others	
Situation	
Task	
Action (what I did)	
Result (with numbers)	
Skills it proves	

Check yourself

☐ I have at least two target roles and one next step for each.

☐ I chose exactly three skills and gave each an hours per week number.

☐ Every skill has at least one proof item planned.

☐ My LinkedIn checklist has been started.

☐ I have four interview stories drafted.

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MANUAL 6

The Premortem

Imagine the plan has already failed. Then find out why.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
20 minutes	Your three biggest risks, each with a safeguard in your calendar	Right after you write your goal

Why it matters

Most plans assume the best case. Psychologist Gary Klein, who studies how experts make decisions, described the premortem method in the Harvard Business Review in 2007. You imagine that the plan has failed, then write the reasons. A 1989 study by Deborah Mitchell, J. Edward Russo, and Nancy Pennington on "prospective hindsight" found that people explain future outcomes in richer detail when they imagine the outcome has already happened. Kahneman and Tversky's planning fallacy explains why this helps: we routinely underestimate how many obstacles will appear.

How to do it

1. **Write your goal** in one sentence at the top of the sheet.
2. **Set the scene.** It is December 2027. The goal did not happen, and you are disappointed.
3. **Write for five minutes.** List every reason it failed. Do not filter. Include the uncomfortable ones.
4. **Circle the three most likely** and score each from 1 to 5.
5. **Write a safeguard for each one** and put it in your calendar with a date.
6. **Ask one other person** the question at the bottom of the page.

6A. Goal and scene

My goal:

It is December 2027 and this did not happen because...

6B. Five minutes of reasons

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6C. Risk and safeguard plan

Reason it could fail	Likelihood (1 to 5)	My safeguard	In my calendar on

6D. The four common failure patterns

Pattern	Does it threaten me? (Y / N)	My safeguard
The motivation cliff.Energy is high in January and gone by March.		
The scope trap.The goal was too big, so every week felt behind.		
The isolation problem.Nobody knew, so nobody noticed when it slipped.		
The missing feedback loop.I never checked if the plan was working.		

6E. Ask another person

Ask a mentor or peer: **"If this plan fails, what do you think will be the reason?"** Listen without defending. Write what they say.

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Check yourself

☐ I wrote at least eight reasons without filtering.

☐ Each of my top three risks has a safeguard.

☐ Every safeguard is in my calendar, not only in my head.

☐ Someone else has told me the risk I could not see.

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MANUAL 7

The Habit Design Lab

Motivation starts habits. Your environment keeps them alive.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
30 minutes	One or two habits designed to stick and a 54 day tracker	Before Monday, November 9

Why it matters

You may have heard that a habit takes 21 days. That number has no solid research behind it. A 2010 study by Phillippa Lally and colleagues found that it took about 66 days on average for a new daily behavior to feel automatic, with a very wide range from person to person, and that missing a single day did not derail the process. Wendy Wood's research on habits shows that much of daily behavior is driven by context cues, not willpower. So the best strategy is to start small and design your surroundings.

How to do it

1. **Choose one habit** tied to your main goal. Add a second only if the first feels easy.
2. **Shrink it** to a version you cannot fail, under five minutes.
3. **Attach it to a cue:** something you already do daily, such as after morning coffee.
4. **Design the space.** Make the right action easy and the distracting action harder.
5. **Track it daily** on the grid. Apply the rule:never miss twice.
6. **Grow** it only after the small version is automatic.

7A. Habit blueprint

Habit 1	
The habit (what I will do)	
Tiny version (under 5 minutes)	
My cue: "After I..."	
Where I will do it	
Friction I will REMOVE (make it easy)	
Friction I will ADD (to distractions)	
My reward	
Who will check on me	
My "never miss twice" fallback	

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Habit 2	
The habit (what I will do)	
Tiny version (under 5 minutes)	
My cue: "After I..."	
Where I will do it	
Friction I will REMOVE (make it easy)	
Friction I will ADD (to distractions)	
My reward	
Who will check on me	
My "never miss twice" fallback	

7B. Environment checklist

☐ My materials are set out where I will use them (notebook open, file saved on the home screen).

☐ My phone is in another room during practice or focus time.

☐ Notifications are off for the apps that pull me away.

☐ I have a dedicated spot, even a small corner, for focused work.

☐ My favorite podcast, coffee, or playlist is saved as a reward for practice sessions.

A fair note: the average of 66 days comes from one study of simple daily behaviors. Your own timeline may be shorter or longer. What matters is repetition, not a deadline.

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7C. 54 day tracker: Habit 1

Habit: _____ Start: Sunday, November 8 Finish: Thursday, December 31

Day 1 Nov 8 ☐	Day 2 Nov 9 ☐	Day 3 Nov 10 ☐	Day 4 Nov 11 ☐	Day 5 Nov 12 ☐	Day 6 Nov 13 ☐	Day 7 Nov 14 ☐	Day 8 Nov 15 ☐	Day 9 Nov 16 ☐
Day 10 Nov 17 ☐	Day 11 Nov 18 ☐	Day 12 Nov 19 ☐	Day 13 Nov 20 ☐	Day 14 Nov 21 ☐	Day 15 Nov 22 ☐	Day 16 Nov 23 ☐	Day 17 Nov 24 ☐	Day 18 Nov 25 ☐
Day 19 Nov 26 ☐	Day 20 Nov 27 ☐	Day 21 Nov 28 ☐	Day 22 Nov 29 ☐	Day 23 Nov 30 ☐	Day 24 Dec 1 ☐	Day 25 Dec 2 ☐	Day 26 Dec 3 ☐	Day 27 Dec 4 ☐
Day 28 Dec 5 ☐	Day 29 Dec 6 ☐	Day 30 Dec 7 ☐	Day 31 Dec 8 ☐	Day 32 Dec 9 ☐	Day 33 Dec 10 ☐	Day 34 Dec 11 ☐	Day 35 Dec 12 ☐	Day 36 Dec 13 ☐
Day 37 Dec 14 ☐	Day 38 Dec 15 ☐	Day 39 Dec 16 ☐	Day 40 Dec 17 ☐	Day 41 Dec 18 ☐	Day 42 Dec 19 ☐	Day 43 Dec 20 ☐	Day 44 Dec 21 ☐	Day 45 Dec 22 ☐
Day 46 Dec 23 ☐	Day 47 Dec 24 ☐	Day 48 Dec 25 ☐	Day 49 Dec 26 ☐	Day 50 Dec 27 ☐	Day 51 Dec 28 ☐	Day 52 Dec 29 ☐	Day 53 Dec 30 ☐	Day 54 Dec 31 ☐

7D. 54 day tracker: Habit 2

Habit: _____ Start: Sunday, November 8 Finish: Thursday, December 31

Day 1 Nov 8 ☐	Day 2 Nov 9 ☐	Day 3 Nov 10 ☐	Day 4 Nov 11 ☐	Day 5 Nov 12 ☐	Day 6 Nov 13 ☐	Day 7 Nov 14 ☐	Day 8 Nov 15 ☐	Day 9 Nov 16 ☐
Day 10 Nov 17 ☐	Day 11 Nov 18 ☐	Day 12 Nov 19 ☐	Day 13 Nov 20 ☐	Day 14 Nov 21 ☐	Day 15 Nov 22 ☐	Day 16 Nov 23 ☐	Day 17 Nov 24 ☐	Day 18 Nov 25 ☐
Day 19 Nov 26 ☐	Day 20 Nov 27 ☐	Day 21 Nov 28 ☐	Day 22 Nov 29 ☐	Day 23 Nov 30 ☐	Day 24 Dec 1 ☐	Day 25 Dec 2 ☐	Day 26 Dec 3 ☐	Day 27 Dec 4 ☐
Day 28 Dec 5 ☐	Day 29 Dec 6 ☐	Day 30 Dec 7 ☐	Day 31 Dec 8 ☐	Day 32 Dec 9 ☐	Day 33 Dec 10 ☐	Day 34 Dec 11 ☐	Day 35 Dec 12 ☐	Day 36 Dec 13 ☐
Day 37 Dec 14 ☐	Day 38 Dec 15 ☐	Day 39 Dec 16 ☐	Day 40 Dec 17 ☐	Day 41 Dec 18 ☐	Day 42 Dec 19 ☐	Day 43 Dec 20 ☐	Day 44 Dec 21 ☐	Day 45 Dec 22 ☐
Day 46 Dec 23 ☐	Day 47 Dec 24 ☐	Day 48 Dec 25 ☐	Day 49 Dec 26 ☐	Day 50 Dec 27 ☐	Day 51 Dec 28 ☐	Day 52 Dec 29 ☐	Day 53 Dec 30 ☐	Day 54 Dec 31 ☐

Check yourself

- ☐ My habit is small enough that I cannot fail it.
- ☐ It has a cue, a place, and a reward.
- ☐ I removed one friction and added one barrier to a distraction.
- ☐ I know the "never miss twice" rule and have a fallback version.

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MANUAL 8

The People Plan

Opportunity travels through people. Build the network on purpose.

TIME N EEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
40 minutes	A personal board, ten reconnect targets, a givingThen plan, and boundaries	send your first two messages the same day

Why it matters

Three pieces of research shape this manual. Mark Granovetter's 1973 study found that many job seekers heard about openings from acquaintances they saw only occasionally, because close friends tend to know what you already know. Adam Grant's work shows that the most successful givers are strategic about whom they help and how. Sylvia Ann Hewlett's research on sponsorship adds that a mentor advises you, while a sponsor uses their influence to speak for you when you are not in the room. Julianne Holt-Lunstad's 2010 meta analysis also found that strong relationships are linked with better survival, so relationships are part of health, not a luxury.

How to do it

1. **Build your personal board.** Fill in the six roles, even if some names are only candidates.
2. **List ten people** you respect and have lost touch with. Send the first two messages today using the scripts at the back.
3. **Plan your giving.** List five specific ways you can help others in the next 54 days.
4. **Appreciate three people.** Say exactly what they did and why it mattered.
5. **Set three boundaries** that protect your energy.

8A. Your personal board

Role	Name (or candidate)	What I need from them	My first ask (date)
Coach for skills			
Guide for direction			
Peer for honesty			
Sponsor in progress			
Accountability partner			
Someone I can help			

8B. The reconnect ten

Lead with them, not with you. Keep it to two or three sentences. Ask for nothing on the first message.

DO NOT DUPLICATE

Name	How I know them	Last spoke	What I will say	Sent on	Reply

8C. Appreciation notes

Person	What exactly I appreciate	Sent?

8D. My giving plan

Give where you are strong: share what you learn, make introductions, offer specific feedback, credit others publicly, or offer a skill.

Who	What I will offer	By when

8E. Boundaries that protect my energy

I will STOP...	I will START...	I will LIMIT...

I will STOP...	I will START...	I will LIMIT...

8F. Make my results visible

Sponsors advocate for people whose work they have seen. List the results you will share with decision makers before December 31, and how you will share them.

Result to share	Who should see it	How and when

Check yourself

☐ My board has at least three real names.

☐ I sent at least two reconnect messages today.

☐ I have five specific ways to give.

☐ I have shared or planned to share at least one visible result.

DO NOT DUPLICATE

MANUAL 9

Money and Negotiation Prep

Whoever speaks first shapes the room. Arrive prepared to be that person.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
45 minutes	Your researched range, your walk away point, and a rehearsed script	Before any offer, review, or rate conversation

Why it matters

In 1974, Amos Tversky and Daniel Kahneman showed that people's estimates are pulled toward the first number they hear, a pattern called anchoring. In 2001, Adam Galinsky and Thomas Mussweiler found that first offers in negotiations act as strong anchors, and that negotiators who focused on the other side's goals and alternatives were less affected by the other party's anchor. The practical lesson is that preparation beats charm.

How to do it

1. **Research your range** from at least three sources: job postings that list pay, salary surveys, and peers in similar roles and cities.
2. **Set your three numbers:** low, target, and high. Then decide your walk away point.
3. **List five results** you have delivered, each with a number. This is your evidence.
4. **Study the other side.** What do they need, what pressures do they face, and what alternatives do they have?
5. **Write your script** and say it out loud until it stops feeling strange.

9A. Market range research

Source	Role, level, and location	Low	Mid	High	Date checked

9B. My numbers

Item	My answer
My low number	
My target number	

Item	My answer
My high number (the "anchor" if I speak first)	
My walk away point (minimum total package)	
Things I will not trade away	

9C. My evidence: five results with numbers

Result I delivered	The number or proof

9D. Beyond base pay: what else is negotiable?

☐ Signing bonus
☐ Review and raise timeline (for example, a six month review)
☐ Learning and certification budget
☐ Remote or hybrid flexibility
☐ Title and scope
☐ Paid time off
☐ Equipment and home office support
☐ Equity or profit sharing
☐ Relocation support
☐ Start date

9E. My script

If they name the number first
☐ Pause. Silence is allowed.
☐ Compare it to my range, not to my feelings.
☐ Counter with reasons: market data plus my results.
☐ If base pay is fixed, widen the conversation to the items in 9D.

DO NOT DUPLICATE

9F. Practice log

Date	Practiced with	What I practiced	Confidence after (1 to 5)

This is general career education. It is not financial or legal advice. Pay laws and rules about pay history questions vary by location.

Check yourself

- ☐ My range comes from at least three sources.
- ☐ I know my walk away point before any conversation.
- ☐ I can state five results with numbers.
- ☐ I said my script out loud at least twice.

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MANUAL 10

The Focus and Energy System

Your attention is the one resource you cannot buy more of.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
30 minutes	A weekly time map, a focus routine, and a body reset plan	Set it up Sunday, run it Monday

Why it matters

Gloria Mark's research on interruptions found that knowledge workers switch tasks often and can take a long time to return fully to the original task. Sophie Leroy's 2009 study described attention residue: part of your mind stays on the task you just left, and performance on the next task suffers. Focus is not a personality trait. It is a system, and it runs on a body that is rested and moving.

How to do it

1. **Choose tomorrow's one important task** tonight and write it on a sticky note.
2. **Protect one ninety minute block** and treat it like a meeting.
3. **Remove the leaks:** phone in another room, notifications off, extra tabs closed.
4. **Park distractions** on a notepad and return to the task.
5. **Finish cleanly:** before you stop, write one line about where you will restart.
6. **Batch the shallow work:** check messages at set times, not constantly.

10A. My weekly time map

Block the work that matters first: focus blocks for your skills and goal, then habits, then meetings, rest, and people time.

Time	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Early morning							
Morning							
Midday							
Afternoon							
Evening							
Night							

DO NOT DUPLICATE

10B. Attention leak audit

My attention leak	How often it happens	My fix

My work day ends at _____ and I will protect that time by...

10C. The body reset plan

Your career runs on the same body as everything else. Start from where you are and build. If you have a medical concern, speak with a qualified professional.

Area	Today I...	My 54 day target
Sleep (adult guidance: at least seven hours)		
Movement (start where you are, then build)		
Food (nourishing meals, fewer snacks and fast food)		
Water		
Short breaks (stand, stretch, walk)		
Five quiet minutes (breathing, meditation, or a walk)		

A note on steps: the popular 10,000 step target began as a marketing slogan for a Japanese pedometer in the 1960s. Research suggests health benefits begin at lower daily step counts, and more movement generally adds more benefit. Choose a target that fits your life now.

DO NOT DUPLICATE

Check yourself

☐ I chose tomorrow's one important task.

☐ My calendar has at least three protected focus blocks this week.

☐ I named my top three attention leaks and one fix for each.

☐ I have one sleep target and one movement target.

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MANUAL 11

Mind and Confidence

Feeling like a fraud does not mean you are one.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
30 minutes	An evidence file, a gratitude log, and a kinder inner voice	Start tonight, repeat weekly

Why it matters

In 1978, Pauline Clance and Suzanne Imes described the impostor phenomenon: capable people who credit success to luck and fear being found out. It is common, and it often appears when people enter something new. Two other findings help. In a 2003 study, Robert Emmons and Michael McCullough found that people who regularly wrote about things they were grateful for reported better well being than comparison groups, although effects were modest. In 2012, Juliana Breines and Serena Chen found that self compassion after failure was linked with greater motivation to improve.

How to do it

1. Keep your evidence file (start with Manual 1) and add to it every week.
2. Write three gratitude lines every night for seven nights. Be specific.
3. Catch harsh thoughts and rewrite them in the table.
4. Plan your rest. Rest is more than sleep.
5. Tidy your digital life with the checklist.
6. Plan one new thing a month so you keep growing.

11A. Seven nights of gratitude

Night	Three specific things I am grateful for
Night 1	
Night 2	
Night 3	
Night 4	
Night 5	
Night 6	
Night 7	

DO NOT DUPLICATE

11B. Rewrite the harsh voice

The harsh thought	A version that is kind and still honest
Example: "I am behind everyone."	Example: "I started later than some. I am making measurable progress, and I compare myself to who I was last year."

When I fail, I will say to myself:

1. Acknowledge: "This is hard, and it hurts."
2. Remember you are not alone: "Many capable people go through this."
3. Take the next step:"What is one small thing I can do next?"

11C. A menu of rest

Type of rest	What it looks like for me	When I will do it
Physical (sleep, naps, stretching)		
Mental (breaks from screens and decisions)		
Social (time with people who lift me)		
Creative (music, nature, making something)		
Quiet (silence, prayer, meditation, reflection)		

11D. Digital declutter checklist

☐ Cancel subscriptions I no longer use.
☐ Clear out my photo gallery and downloads.
☐ Delete contacts and apps I no longer need.
☐ Unsubscribe from ten emails that only add noise.
☐ Turn off notifications that do not need me right now.
☐ Unfollow accounts that leave me feeling smaller.

11E. One new thing a month

Month	The new thing I will try	Done?
November 2026		☐
December 2026		☐
January 2027		☐
February 2027		☐
March 2027		☐
April 2027		☐

This workbook is general education, not medical advice. If low mood, anxiety, or stress feels heavy or lasts, please speak with a doctor or licensed professional. Reaching out is strength.

Check yourself

☐ I finished at least three nights of gratitude lines.
☐ I rewrote at least three harsh thoughts.
☐ I picked one form of rest I will schedule this week.
☐ I know my first new thing for November.

MANUAL 12

The 54 Day Sprint

You do not need a new year to start. You need a plan for the next eight weeks.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
40 minutes	Your week by week plan from November 9 to December 31	Sunday, November 8, so you start Monday ready

Why it matters

In 2014, Hengchen Dai, Katherine Milkman, and Jason Riis described the fresh start effect: people are more likely to pursue goals right after temporal landmarks such as a new week, a new month, or a new year. You do not have to wait for January. This sprint uses three landmarks you already have:Monday, November 9 (a new week),Tuesday, December 1 (a new month), andFriday, January 1(a new year). Each one is a chance to review and restart.

How to do it

1. Complete the Sunday setup checklist below.
2. Fill in all eight weeks now, even roughly. You can adjust later.
3. Run the Sunday review every week using the review pages at the back.
4. Reset on December 1 with the monthly review, treating it as a second fresh start.
5. Finish on December 31 with the year end review and launch 2027 already in motion.

12A. Sunday, November 8: the setup checklist

☐ My main goal is written (Manual 4).
☐ I chose one or two habits and set the cue (Manual 7).
☐ My focus blocks for next week are in my calendar (Manual 10).
☐ I created a document called "Evidence" and added three wins (Manual 1).
☐ I told one person my goal and asked them to check on me in a week.
☐ I sent two reconnect messages (Manual 8).
☐ My workspace is ready: notebook open, phone away, materials set out.

12B. The eight week plan

Suggested themes are in the second column. Replace them if your goal needs something different.

Week and dates	Suggested theme	My three priorities	The result I will have by Sunday
Week 1 Nov 9 to 15	Foundation: set up the systems		
Week 2 Nov 16 to 22	Skill depth: three focused blocks		

Week and dates	Suggested theme	My three priorities	The result I will have by Sunday
Week 3 Nov 23 to 29	Visibility: share one piece of work. (Thanksgiving week: plan lighter.)		
Week 4 Nov 30 to Dec 6	Reset: December 1 monthly review		
Week 5 Dec 7 to 13	Conversations: reconnect and ask		
Week 6 Dec 14 to 20	Output: apply, present, or ship		
Week 7 Dec 21 to 27	Refine and rest: fix what is not working. (Holiday week: protect rest.)		
Week 8 Dec 28 to 31	Finish: year end review and 2027 launch		

12C. My three landmarks

Landmark	What I will do to mark it
Monday, November 9: new week	
Tuesday, December 1: new month	
Friday, January 1: new year	

Check yourself

- ☐ All eight weeks have at least one priority.
- ☐ My three landmarks each have an action.
- ☐ My Sunday review is in my calendar for every week.
- ☐ I know what I will do on Monday morning at the start of my first focus block.

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BONUS MANUAL

The Mentorship Decision Kit

Do not take our word for it. Take the test.

TIME NEEDED	YOU WILL PRODUCE	BEST DONE
45 minutes	A clear, evidence based decision on whether structured mentorship is worth it for you	Before you commit money or time to any program, including ours

Why this manual exists

Skepticism is healthy. You have probably watched free videos, bought a course, or joined a program that did not deliver. So we will not ask you to believe anything. This kit gives you a method to judgeanymentorship program, a calculator to test whether the numbers make sense for you, and a scorecard to compare us honestly against every alternative, including doing it alone.

If Babskenky Mentorship is the right fit, the evidence will show it. If another path is better for you, this kit will show that too.

39	20+	Jun 2025
mentees with job offers, some with several offers at once	years of mentoring and advocating for people into technology careers	Babskenky and FairChild Institute founded

We Don't Teach Courses. We Change Tax Brackets.™ Our focus is the outcome that matters: your role, your income, and your career trajectory, not hours of video watched.

B1. The honest math: is it worth it?

Use your own numbers from Manual 9. This is an estimate, not a promise. Real results vary with effort, market conditions, and starting point.

Line	My numbers	How to calculate
A. My current annual income		From your records
B. Annual income in my target role (realistic, not best case)		From your Manual 9 research
C. Yearly gain from reaching the target		B minus A
D. Monthly gain		C divided by 12
E. Months it would take me alone (honest estimate)		Think about how long you have already been trying
F. Months it would take with structured mentorship (honest estimate)		Ask the program for realistic timelines
G. Months saved		E minus F

DO NOT DUPLICATE

Line	My numbers	How to calculate
H. Value of the time saved		D times G
I. Total program investment	[ADD: your investment] Total	cost, including all fees
J. Return multiple		H divided by I
K. Break even		I divided by D = months of the new income needed to pay it back

Worked illustration (not a promise)

If a target role pays $20,000 more per year, the gain is about $1,667 a month. If structured mentorship helped you start six months sooner, those six months are worth about $10,000 before taxes. Change the numbers to match your life.

The cost of waiting: every month of delay costs you your monthly gain in line D. Waiting is a decision with a price.

B2. The 1% Value Scorecard

Score each option from 1 (weak) to 5 (excellent). Be fair, and ask the questions in B3 before you score. The best choice for you is the one that scores highest on the criteria that matter most to your goal.

Criterion	What top tier looks like	Babskenky Mentorship	Program B	Doing it alone
1. Verifiable outcomes	Named people, real roles, willing to speak with you			
2. Practitioner led	Taught by people who do the work now			
3. Structure and accountability	Deadlines, cohorts, regular check ins			
4. Feedback loops	Reviewed work, mock interviews, direct answers fast			
5. Career support	Resume, LinkedIn, interviews, negotiation			
6. Community and continuity	Peers and access that continue after the program			
7. Transparency	Cost, schedule, and expectations in writing, no pressure			
8. Fit	Matches your goal, timeline, and learning style			
TOTAL (out of 40)				

DO NOT DUPLICATE

B3. Ten questions to ask any mentorship program

Ask us all ten. Ask every other program all ten. Write what you hear. A strong program welcomes these questions.

Question	A strong answer sounds like	What I heard
1. Can I speak with two current or former mentees?	Yes, and they are free to be honest with you.	
2. What happened to people who did not get results, and why?	A candid answer about effort, fit, and market, not "everyone succeeds."	
3. What exactly will I do each week?	A clear schedule with deliverables, not only "access."	
4. Who gives me feedback, and how quickly?	Named people and a stated response time.	
5. What is NOT included?	A clear list. Surprises are a warning sign.	
6. What is the total cost and payment structure, in writing?	Everything up front, with no pressure to decide today.	
7. What do you need from me?	Specific time, effort, and effort standards.	
8. How do you keep the content current?	Instructors who work in the field and update materials.	
9. What happens after the program ends?	Continued community, access, or a path to keep growing.	
10. Do you guarantee a job?	No honest program can guarantee a job offer. Be careful with anyone who does.	

B4. Red flags and green flags

Red flags: walk away or ask harder questions	Green flags: lean in
Guaranteed jobs or guaranteed salaries	Honest about what is in your control and what is not
No named instructors or mentors	Named practitioners you can look up
Vague outcomes ("transform your life")	Specific outcomes with real, checkable examples
Pressure to pay today or lose the offer	Time to ask questions and decide
Only testimonials, no one you can speak to	Mentees willing to talk to you directly
Content only, with no feedback or accountability	Reviewed work, check ins, and deadlines

DO NOT DUPLICATE

B5. Why structured mentorship works: five mechanisms

Mechanism	What the research says	What to look for
Feedback and deliberate practice	Anders Ericsson's research found that expert level skill comes from focused practice on specific weaknesses with feedback, not from hours alone.	Reviewed work, mock interviews, corrections
Access to people	Mark Granovetter's weak ties research and Sylvia Ann Hewlett's work on sponsorship show that information and advocacy travel through people.	Introductions, communities, mentors who speak up for you
Accountability	Goal setting research (Locke and Latham) shows that specific goals with feedback improve performance.	Deadlines, reviews, check ins
Social support	Julianne Holt-Lunstad's 2010 meta analysis linked strong relationships with better survival, a sign of how much relationships matter.	Cohorts, peers, alumni
Evidence of mentoring effects	A 2004 meta analysis by Tammy Allen and colleagues found that mentored people reported better career outcomes, though effects were modest. That is why program quality matters.	Use the ten questions in B3

B6. The questions skeptics ask us

What you might be thinking	Our honest answer
"I can learn everything free online."	You can learn most content free. Content is not the scarce part. Structure, feedback, accountability, and access to people are. A useful test: how many free courses have you started, and how many have you finished and turned into a role?
"Will I definitely get a job?"	No honest program can promise that, and we will not. What we can do is show you real outcomes you can verify, give you a structure and feedback to improve your odds, and hold you to the work. Your effort and the market also matter.
"I have been burned before."	That is a fair reason to be careful. Use B3 and B4 with us and with everyone else. Speak to mentees directly before you decide.
"I have no experience."	Many career changers begin here. Your Evidence File in Manual 1 will show more transferable skills than you expect.
"I do not have the time."	Most people overestimate what they can do in a week and underestimate what twenty to thirty focused minutes a day does over fifty four days. Manual 10 shows how to find the time.
"Is it worth the money?"	Use B1. If the numbers do not work for your situation, do not join. If they do, the cost of waiting is already in line D.

B7. Proof you can check

We invite you to verify, not just believe. Ask for any of the following.

DO NOT DUPLICATE

☐ **Speak with current and former mentees** about what the work was really like.

☐ **See real outcomes.** Our mentees have received job offers, some with multiple offers at the same time. Ask to hear how.

☐ **Meet the instructors** and see what they do for a living.

☐ **Review the curriculum** for the track you want.

☐ **Ask what comes after the program**including the FairChild Fellowship for Continuous Development.

Mentee story cards

Real stories, shared with permission.

	Story 1	Story 2	Story 3
Name and role	[ADD: with permission]	[ADD: with permission]	[ADD: with permission]
Where they started			
What they did			
The result			
In their own words			

B8. Your decision

Question	My answer
What is the one result I want most in the next 12 months?	
Based on B1, does the math work for me?	
Based on B2, which option scored highest on my top three criteria?	
What am I still unsure about, and who can answer it?	
My decision and the date I will decide by	

Next steps with Babskenky Mentorship

Ask your questions. Message us on WhatsApp at +1 (347) 766-1809 or email info@fairchildinstitute.com.

See the details: fairchildinstitute.com

Investment and enrollment terms: [ADD: program name, investment, payment options, and enrollment deadline]

Our commitment to you: [ADD: any guarantee or terms you offer, exactly as you will honor them]

DO NOT DUPLICATE

WEEKLY REVIEW

The Sunday Review #1

Ten minutes every Sunday keeps the whole plan honest.

Week of: _____ Energy this week (1 to 10):_____ Habits kept (out of 7):_____

Look back

Question	My answer
My top three wins this week	
Progress on my main goal (what moved, by how much)	
What drained me or slowed me down	
One lesson I will carry forward	

Look ahead

Item	My answer
My top three priorities next week	
The one bet I will place on myself	
Who I will reach out to or thank	
Help I need, and from whom	
The first task Monday morning	

Add to the Evidence File

☐ I updated my tracker.

☐ My focus blocks for next week are in my calendar.

☐ I sent at least one message to a person.

DO NOT DUPLICATE

WEEKLY REVIEW

The Sunday Review #2

Ten minutes every Sunday keeps the whole plan honest.

Week of: _____ Energy this week (1 to 10):_____ Habits kept (out of 7):_____

Look back

Question	My answer
My top three wins this week	
Progress on my main goal (what moved, by how much)	
What drained me or slowed me down	
One lesson I will carry forward	

Look ahead

Item	My answer
My top three priorities next week	
The one bet I will place on myself	
Who I will reach out to or thank	
Help I need, and from whom	
The first task Monday morning	

Add to the Evidence File

☐ I updated my tracker.

☐ My focus blocks for next week are in my calendar.

☐ I sent at least one message to a person.

DO NOT DUPLICATE

MONTHLY RESET

The December 1 Review

A new month is a fresh start. Use it.

Question	My answer
What did I complete in November?	
What did I plan and not complete? Why?	
What is working that I should do more of?	
What is not working that I should drop or change?	
Is my main goal still the right goal? What needs adjusting?	
My three priorities for December	
A new landmark I will create for myself	
What I will reward myself with	

Check yourself

☐ I updated my goal sheet.

☐ I adjusted my habits if needed.

☐ I contacted at least three people in my plan.

DO NOT DUPLICATE

YEAR END

The December 31 Review

Finish 2026 in motion, not at zero.

Question	My answer
What did I accomplish in the 54 days?	
What am I most proud of?	
Which habit became automatic?	
Which people did I reconnect with or help?	
What did I learn about myself?	
What carries into January, and what stops here?	
My first three actions on January 1	
What I want to thank myself for	

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YOUR COMMITMENT

My 2027 Commitment Contract

A promise to yourself, said out loud and signed.

Read this aloud. Then sign it, and share it with one person.

I, _____, commit to the following between **November 9 and December 31, 2026:**

1. My main goal for 2027 is: _____
2. I will work on it for _____ minutes a day, at _____ (time), in _____ (place).
3. My daily habit is: _____
4. I will send _____ messages a week to people in my plan.
5. I will complete my Sunday review every week.
6. When I miss a day, I will not miss twice.
7. The person who will check on me is: _____

I will measure my success on December 31 by:

_____

	Signature	Date
Me		
My accountability partner		

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APPENDIX A

The Script Library

Borrow these words. Adapt them to your voice.

1. Reconnect after a long silence

"Hi [Name], I saw your update about [specific thing] and wanted to say congratulations. It is well deserved. I would love to hear what you are working on these days if you have a few minutes to catch up."

2. Ask for ten minutes of guidance

"Hi [Name], I admire how you moved from [A] to [B]. I am working toward [goal]. Could I ask you two questions in a ten minute call? I will come prepared and keep to time."

3. Follow up after advice (the step that earns a mentor's investment)

"Thank you again for your advice. I tried [action], and here is what happened: [result]. One question I have now is [question]."

4. Ask for an introduction

"Would you be comfortable introducing me to [Name]? I wrote a short note you can forward, so it takes you less than a minute."

5. Ask for feedback

"I am working to improve [skill]. What is one thing I could do differently next time?"

6. State your salary range

"Based on my research of similar roles and the results I have delivered, I am looking for a total package in the range of [range]. I am excited about this role and happy to talk through how we can get there."

7. Counter an offer

"Thank you for the offer. I am excited about the role. Based on [market data and my results], I was hoping for [number]. Is there flexibility to get closer to that?"

8. Decline kindly

"I would love to help, but I cannot take this on right now. Here is what I can do instead: [smaller option, resource, or referral]."

DO NOT DUPLICATE

9. Thank you after an interview (within 24 hours)

"Thank you for your time today. I enjoyed learning about [specific topic]. Our conversation made me more excited about [specific part of the role]. I am confident I can contribute to [specific goal], and I would be glad to answer any further questions."

10. Share a result with a decision maker

"Quick update: we completed [project]. The impact was [number or outcome]. Next, I plan to [next step]. I would welcome your thoughts."

Elevator pitch template

Part	My version
Present: I am a... who helps...	
Past: I have delivered... (one proof point)	
Future: I am now looking to...	

LinkedIn headline and About formulas

Element	Formula	My draft
Headline	Role or specialty | who you help or what you do | one proof point	
About: line 1	A hook: the problem you solve or the result you create	
About: middle	Proof: two or three results with numbers	
About: close	What you are looking for and how to reach you	

APPENDIX B

Interview Preparation Pack

Outline your answers now. Rehearse out loud later.

For each question, write three bullet points, not a speech. Use your STAR stories from Manual 5.

Question	What they are really asking	My answer outline
Tell me about yourself.	Why are you a fit? Keep it present, past, future.	
Why this role and this company?	Have you done your homework?	
What is your greatest strength?	Will your strength help us?	
What is a weakness you are working on?	Are you self aware and improving?	
Tell me about a failure.	Do you learn and take ownership?	
Tell me about a conflict.	Can you work with people?	
Tell me about a time you led without authority.	Can you influence?	
Why are you leaving or changing fields?	Will you stay and commit?	
Where do you see yourself in five years?	Do your goals fit our path?	
What is your salary expectation?	Have you prepared? (Manual 9)	

Questions I will ask them

☐ What does success look like in this role in the first 90 days?

☐ What are the biggest challenges the team is facing right now?

☐ How does the team give feedback and support growth?

☐ What are the next steps and timeline?

My own questions:

DO NOT DUPLICATE

APPENDIX C

The Research Behind The Manuals

You can look every one of these up. We encourage you to.

These are the main studies and ideas used in this workbook, described in plain words. Findings describe patterns across groups, and individual results vary.

Idea	Researchers and year	In plain words	Manual
Progress and motivation	Teresa Amabile and Steven Kramer, The Progress Principle (2011)	Seeing progress in meaningful work is one of the strongest drivers of a good workday.	1
Goal setting	Edwin Locke and Gary Latham (1990 and later)	Specific, challenging goals generally lead to better performance than vague ones.	4
Premortem	Gary Klein, Harvard Business Review (2007)	Imagine the plan failed, then write why. It reveals risks people otherwise stay quiet about.	6
Prospective hindsight	Deborah Mitchell, J. Edward Russo, Nancy Pennington (1989)	Imagining an event as already happened produces richer explanations of why.	6
Planning fallacy	Daniel Kahneman and Amos Tversky (1979)	We underestimate the time and obstacles our plans will need.	6
Habit formation	Phillippa Lally and colleagues (2010)	On average about 66 days to feel automatic, with a very wide range. One missed day did not derail7 it.	
Habits and context	Wendy Wood (2019 and earlier)	Much of what we do is driven by context cues, so design your surroundings.	7
Weak ties	Mark Granovetter (1973)	Job leads often come from acquaintances because they carry information your close circle8 lacks.	
Givers, takers, matchers	Adam Grant (2013)	Givers appear at both ends of the success ladder. Strategic giving separates them.	8
Mentoring and sponsorship	Kathy Kram (1983); Tammy Allen and colleagues (2004); Sylvia Ann Hewlett (2013)	Mentored people report better career outcomes, though effects are modest. Sponsors speak for you in rooms you are not in.	8, B
Relationships and health	Julianne Holt-Lunstad and colleagues (2010)	Strong social relationships are linked with better survival.	8
Anchoring	Amos Tversky and Daniel Kahneman (1974)	People's estimates are pulled toward the first number they hear.	9
First offers in negotiation	Adam Galinsky and Thomas Mussweiler (2001)	First offers act as anchors. Thinking about the other side reduces their pull.	9
Interruptions and attention	Gloria Mark (various)	Frequent task switching hurts focused work, and recovery takes time.	10

DO NOT DUPLICATE

Idea	Researchers and year	In plain words	Manual
Attention residue	Sophie Leroy (2009)	Part of your attention stays on the previous task after you switch.	10
Impostor phenomenon	Pauline Clance and Suzanne Imes (1978)	Capable people often credit success to luck and fear being found out.	11
Gratitude	Robert Emmons and Michael McCullough (2003)	Regularly writing about gratitude was linked with better well being. Effects are modest.	11
Self compassion	Juliana Breines and Serena Chen (2012)	Self compassion after failure was linked with greater motivation to improve.	11
Fresh start effect	Hengchen Dai, Katherine Milkman, Jason Riis (2014)	People are more likely to start goals after new weeks, months, and years.	12
Deliberate practice	Anders Ericsson (various)	Expert level skill comes from focused practice on weaknesses with feedback.	B

This workbook is general career education, not financial, legal, or medical advice.

BABSKELL

SESSION NOTES

Notes From Today's Session

Capture ideas now. Turn them into actions in your next review.

The top roles for 2027 I heard about:

What I learned about the FairChild Fellowship for Continuous Development:

The most useful idea I heard today:

Questions I still want answered (I will message them on WhatsApp):

Three actions I will take in the next 48 hours:

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THE LAST PAGE

Now Go Do The Work

Plans change lives only when they are acted on.

You now have a look back at 2026, an honest picture of your life, a why, a goal, a career roadmap, a risk plan, a habit, a people plan, a money plan, a focus system, a stronger inner voice, and a 54 day sprint. The only thing missing is Monday.

Your next three moves

1. Tonight: sign your commitment contract and tell one person.
2. Sunday, November 8: complete the setup checklist in Manual 12.
3. Monday, November 9: start your first focus block.

Stay connected

FairChild Institute x Babskenky

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Babskenky!!!